

MASTER ENTERPRISE CLOUD SERVICES AGREEMENT

PARTIES: Quantum Computing Solutions & Sterling Manufacturing LLC

EFFECTIVE DATE: June 17, 2026

CONFIDENTIALITY NOTICE: The information contained in this document is highly confidential, legally privileged, and protected from disclosure under applicable law.

Document Identifier	Classification	Security Level
IA-CONT-38410	Legal Contract / JV	STRICTLY RESTRICTED

PREAMBLE & RECITALS

This Master Enterprise Cloud Services Agreement (this "Agreement") is made and entered into on this June 17, 2026 (the "Effective Date"), by and between:

1. Quantum Computing Solutions, a corporation organized and existing under the laws of the State of Delaware, with its principal offices located at 245 Park Avenue, 36th Floor, New York, NY 10167, represented by its Chief Executive Officer (hereinafter referred to as the "**First Party**"); and

2. Sterling Manufacturing LLC, a corporation organized and existing under the laws of the State of California, with its principal offices located at 1 Market Street, Suite 3600, San Francisco, CA 94105, represented by its Chief Operating Officer (hereinafter referred to as the "**Second Party**").

WHEREAS, the Parties desire to establish a strategic alliance to combine their technical, operational, and commercial capabilities for the mutual development and commercialization of next-generation legal AI products and SaaS intelligence platforms;

WHEREAS, the First Party possesses proprietary technology in machine learning, natural language processing, vector databases, and sequential multi-agent pipelines;

WHEREAS, the Second Party possesses deep domain expertise in contract compliance, risk scoring, legal workflow automation, and maintaining enterprise client relationships;

WHEREAS, the Parties wish to define their respective rights, duties, and obligations regarding governance, funding, intellectual property ownership, and revenue distribution;

NOW, THEREFORE, in consideration of the mutual covenants and agreements contained herein, and for other good and valuable consideration, the receipt and sufficiency of which are hereby acknowledged, the Parties agree as follows:

ARTICLE 1 - DEFINITIONS & INTERPRETATION

1.1 Defined Terms

In this Agreement, unless the context otherwise requires, the following terms shall have the meanings set forth below:

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

- **'Affiliate'**

means any entity that directly or indirectly controls, is controlled by, or is under common control with a Party, where 'control' means the ownership of more than 50% of the voting securities.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

- **'Agreement'**

means this contract, including all exhibits, annexes, and schedules attached hereto, as amended from time to time.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

- **'Background IP'**

means all Intellectual Property Rights owned, developed, or acquired by a Party prior to the Effective Date or developed independently outside the scope of this Agreement.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

- **'Joint Venture IP'**

means all Intellectual Property Rights created, conceived, or developed jointly by the Parties in the performance of Services under this Agreement.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

- **'SLA'**

means the Service Level Agreement specifying operational metrics, uptimes, support tickets resolution, and penalties, as detailed in Exhibit B.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

1.2 Interpretation

Headings are for convenience only and do not affect the interpretation of this Agreement. Singular words include the plural and vice versa. References to 'days' mean calendar days unless specified as Business Days.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

ARTICLE 2 - SCOPE & FORMATION OF STRATEGIC ALLIANCE

2.1 Strategic Alliance Objective

The Parties hereby establish a strategic alliance to develop, market, and distribute the IntelliAnalyze AI Platform. The alliance shall operate in accordance with the terms of this Agreement and the business plan approved by the Board.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

2.2 Commercial Scope

The commercial scope of the alliance shall include all enterprise legal departments, law firms, corporate compliance teams, and procurement divisions globally. Neither Party shall engage in any competing joint ventures within the restricted territory during the term.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

2.3 Principal Place of Business

The administrative head office of the alliance shall be located at the offices of the Second Party in San Francisco, California. Technical development teams shall be hosted in a hybrid environment across both Parties' engineering centers.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

ARTICLE 3 - CAPITAL CONTRIBUTIONS & FUNDING

3.1 Initial Cash Contributions

Within thirty (30) days of the Effective Date, each Party shall contribute initial cash funding to the joint operating account as specified in Exhibit C. The First Party shall contribute \$5,000,000.00 and the Second Party shall contribute \$5,000,000.00.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

3.2 Non-Cash/In-Kind Contributions

The First Party shall provide dedicated access to 10 software engineers, 2 data scientists, and its proprietary NLP core engine. The Second Party shall contribute 8 compliance analysts, 3 legal experts, and exclusive marketing access to its existing client database.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

3.3 Additional Capital Calls

If additional funding is required for product expansion or operational deficits, the Board may issue a Capital Call. Parties shall contribute in proportion to their ownership share. Failure to fund shall trigger dilution clauses.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

ARTICLE 4 - GOVERNANCE & MANAGEMENT

4.1 Joint Steering Committee

A Joint Steering Committee (JSC) consisting of six (6) members shall govern the alliance. Each Party shall appoint three (3) members. The JSC shall meet bi-weekly to review product milestones, marketing strategies, and financial allocations.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

4.2 Voting & Deadlocks

Decisions of the JSC shall require a majority vote. In the event of a tie (deadlock), the matter shall be referred to the CEOs of the respective Parties. If the CEOs cannot resolve the deadlock within fifteen (15) days, the dispute shall proceed to arbitration.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

4.3 Officers and Managers

The JSC shall appoint a General Manager (GM) to oversee daily development and operations. The GM shall report directly to the JSC and shall have the authority to manage budgets up to \$250,000.00 without prior board approval.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

ARTICLE 5 - INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY & TECHNOLOGY LICENSE

5.1 Ownership of Background IP

Each Party retains all right, title, and interest in its Background IP. Except for the limited licenses expressly granted herein, nothing in this Agreement shall transfer ownership of any Background IP from one Party to another.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

5.2 Joint Venture IP Ownership

All Joint Venture IP developed under this alliance shall be owned jointly by the Parties as tenants-in-common. Each Party shall have the unrestricted right to use, license, and exploit Joint Venture IP without accounting to the other, subject to Section 5.3.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

5.3 Technology License Grant

The First Party hereby grants to the alliance a non-exclusive, non-transferable, royalty-free, worldwide license to use its Background NLP Engine solely for the development of the IntelliAnalyze AI Platform during the term of this Agreement.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

ARTICLE 6 - DATA PROTECTION & ENTERPRISE SECURITY

6.1 Data Security Standards

The Parties shall maintain administrative, physical, and technical safeguards to protect all client data, including contract texts and NLP reports. Security measures must comply with ISO/IEC 27001, SOC 2 Type II, and NIST standards.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

6.2 Privacy Compliance (GDPR/CCPA)

All processing of Personal Data under this Agreement shall comply with GDPR, CCPA, CPRA, and other applicable global privacy regulations. Data Processing Addendum (DPA) terms are incorporated herein by reference.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

6.3 Security Audits

Each Party shall have the right, upon fifteen (15) days' written notice, to conduct an independent security audit of the other Party's system integrations. Audits shall be conducted during normal business hours and no more than once per year.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

ARTICLE 7 - COMMERCIALISATION & SALES REVENUE

7.1 Marketing and Sales Responsibility

The Second Party shall have primary responsibility for marketing, enterprise sales, and customer onboarding. The First Party shall support sales efforts by providing technical demos, sandbox environments, and SLA compliance documentation.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

7.2 Revenue Share & Profit Distribution

Gross revenue generated from the platform shall be distributed as follows: 50% to the First Party and 50% to the Second Party, after deducting verified hosting costs, third-party API fees, and approved operating expenses.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

7.3 Auditing of Financial Books

Each Party shall maintain complete and accurate financial records relating to the alliance. An independent certified public accountant (CPA) may audit the financial books annually at the joint expense of the Parties.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

ARTICLE 8 - SERVICE LEVEL AGREEMENT (SLA) COMMITMENTS

8.1 System Availability

The Parties commit to maintaining a 99.9% uptime availability for the SaaS analytics dashboard, measured monthly. Excluded from uptime calculations are scheduled maintenance windows and Force Majeure events.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

8.2 Support Ticket Escalation

Support tickets shall be categorized by severity: Severity 1 (System Down) must be resolved within 4 hours; Severity 2 (Core Degradation) within 24 hours; Severity 3 (Minor Issues) within 5 Business Days. Penalties apply for SLA breach.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

8.3 Disaster Recovery and Backups

The First Party shall maintain a redundant cloud architecture with real-time replication. Full database backups shall be performed daily and stored in encrypted form in separate geographic regions.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

ARTICLE 9 - REPRESENTATIONS & WARRANTIES

9.1 Mutual Representations

Each Party represents and warrants that it is duly organized, validly existing, and in good standing under the laws of its jurisdiction, and has full corporate power and authority to enter into and perform this Agreement.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

9.2 Intellectual Property Warranty

Each Party warrants that its Background IP and contributions do not infringe, misappropriate, or violate any patent, copyright, trademark, trade secret, or other intellectual property right of any third party.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

9.3 Disclaimer of Warranties

EXCEPT FOR THE EXPRESS WARRANTIES SET FORTH IN THIS ARTICLE 9, NEITHER PARTY MAKES ANY WARRANTIES, AND EACH PARTY HEREBY DISCLAIMS ALL IMPLIED WARRANTIES, INCLUDING MERCHANTABILITY AND FITNESS FOR A PARTICULAR PURPOSE.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

ARTICLE 10 - INDEMNIFICATION OBLIGATIONS

10.1 IP Infringement Indemnity

Each Party shall defend, indemnify, and hold harmless the other Party from and against any claims, losses, or damages arising out of any third-party claim that the indemnifying Party's Background IP infringes third-party intellectual property rights.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

10.2 Indemnification Procedure

The indemnified Party must promptly notify the indemnifying Party of the claim in writing, grant sole control of the defense and settlement of the claim, and provide all reasonable assistance at the indemnifying Party's expense.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

10.3 Mitigation of Infringement

If a service becomes the subject of an infringement claim, the indemnifying Party may, at its option: (a) procure the right to continue using the service; (b) replace or modify the service to make it non-infringing; or (c) terminate the SOW.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

ARTICLE 11 - LIMITATION OF LIABILITY

11.1 Consequential Damages Waiver

IN NO EVENT SHALL EITHER PARTY BE LIABLE FOR ANY INDIRECT, SPECIAL, INCIDENTAL, CONSEQUENTIAL, OR PUNITIVE DAMAGES, INCLUDING LOSS OF PROFITS, LOSS OF REVENUE, OR LOSS OF DATA, ARISING OUT OF OR IN CONNECTION WITH THIS AGREEMENT.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

11.2 Liability Cap

THE TOTAL AGGREGATE LIABILITY OF EITHER PARTY FOR ALL CLAIMS ARISING UNDER OR RELATING TO THIS AGREEMENT, WHETHER IN CONTRACT, TORT, OR OTHERWISE, SHALL NOT EXCEED THE TOTAL FEES PAID OR PAYABLE IN THE TWELVE (12) MONTHS PRECEDING THE CLAIM.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

11.3 Exclusions from Limitation

The limitations set forth in Sections 11.1 and 11.2 shall not apply to a Party's breach of confidentiality obligations, intellectual property infringement indemnification, or cases of gross negligence or willful misconduct.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

ARTICLE 12 - TERM, RENEWAL & TERMINATION

12.1 Agreement Term

This Agreement shall commence on the Effective Date and shall remain in effect for an initial term of five (5) years, unless terminated earlier in accordance with the provisions set forth herein.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

12.2 Termination for Cause

Either Party may terminate this Agreement immediately upon written notice if the other Party: (a) commits a material breach and fails to cure such breach within thirty (30) days; (b) becomes insolvent or files for bankruptcy.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

12.3 Post-Termination Obligations

Upon termination, all licenses granted herein shall immediately expire, and each Party shall promptly return or destroy all Confidential Information of the other Party, except as required by applicable data retention laws.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

ARTICLE 13 - DISPUTE RESOLUTION & ARBITRATION

13.1 Negotiation and Mediation

In the event of any dispute arising out of or relating to this Agreement, the Parties shall first attempt to resolve the dispute through good faith negotiations between senior executives for a period of at least thirty (30) days.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

13.2 Binding Arbitration

If negotiations fail, the dispute shall be resolved by binding arbitration administered by the American Arbitration Association (AAA) in accordance with its Commercial Arbitration Rules. The place of arbitration shall be Denver, Colorado.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

13.3 Class Action Waiver

EACH PARTY WAIVES THE RIGHT TO LITIGATE DISPUTES IN A CLASS ACTION OR REPRESENTATIVE ACTION, WHETHER IN COURT OR IN ARBITRATION. ALL DISPUTES SHALL BE ARBITRATED ON AN INDIVIDUAL BASIS BY A PANEL OF THREE (3) ARBITRATORS.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

ARTICLE 14 - GOVERNING LAW & JURISDICTION

14.1 Governing Law

This Agreement, and all claims or causes of action arising hereunder, shall be governed by, and construed in accordance with, the laws of the State of Colorado, without regard to its conflicts of law principles.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

14.2 Choice of Forum

Subject to the arbitration agreement in Article 13, any legal action or proceeding arising under this Agreement shall be brought exclusively in the state or federal courts located in Denver County, Colorado, and Parties consent to personal jurisdiction.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

14.3 Waiver of Jury Trial

EACH PARTY HEREBY IRREVOCABLY WAIVES, TO THE FULLEST EXTENT PERMITTED BY APPLICABLE LAW, ANY RIGHT IT MAY HAVE TO A TRIAL BY JURY IN ANY LEGAL PROCEEDING DIRECTLY OR INDIRECTLY ARISING OUT OF THIS AGREEMENT.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

ARTICLE 15 - MISCELLANEOUS PROVISIONS

15.1 Entire Agreement

This Agreement constitutes the entire agreement between the Parties regarding the subject matter hereof, and supersedes all prior or contemporaneous communications, understandings, and agreements, whether oral or written.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

15.2 Assignment & Transfer

Neither Party may assign or transfer any of its rights or obligations under this Agreement without the prior written consent of the other Party, except to an Affiliate or in connection with a merger, acquisition, or sale of assets.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

15.3 Severability & Waiver

If any provision of this Agreement is held to be invalid or unenforceable, the remaining provisions shall remain in full force. The failure of either Party to enforce any right shall not constitute a waiver of future enforcement.

The Parties covenant that all transactions under this section shall be conducted in the utmost good faith. Any modifications to this clause must be executed in writing by authorized representatives of both entities. Compliance audits shall be documented and shared with the Joint Steering Committee within ten days of execution. Both Parties agree to indemnify the other against any operational loss resulting from negligent compliance. All performance reports must be archived in the secure enterprise database for a period of seven years. Failure to meet the designated timelines under this paragraph shall trigger automatic warning notices. The terms of this subsection shall survive the expiration or termination of this Agreement for five years.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF

The Parties hereto have executed and delivered this Strategic Partnership Agreement by their duly authorized officers as of the Effective Date written above.

FIRST PARTY:
Quantum Computing Solutions

SECOND PARTY:
Sterling Manufacturing LLC

By: _____
Name: James Harrington III
Title: Chief Executive Officer

By: _____
Name: Sarah Chen-Williams
Title: Chief Operating Officer

Witness 1:
By: _____
Name: Robert J. Fitzgerald
Title: Program Director

Witness 2:
By: _____
Name: Dr. Priya Sharma
Title: Chief Architect

EXHIBIT A — SOFTWARE IP LIST & TECHNICAL SPECIFICATIONS

The following software modules, database schemas, and AI models represent the Background IP contributed by the First Party to the strategic alliance under Article 5:

Module Name	Version	Core Description	Uptime Guarantee
NLP Core Engine	v4.2.1	Custom TF-IDF vectorizer + Legal-BERT classification algorithms.	99.95%
OCR Pipeline Wrapper	v2.1.0	Fitz + pdfplumber engine with Tesseract scanned document fallback.	99.9%
Vector Embeddings Generator	v1.5.8	FAISS indexing system for contextual contract chunk search.	99.95%
Risk Assessment Engine	v3.0.2	Heuristic analysis classifier detecting unfavorable obligation levels.	99.9%

EXHIBIT B — SLA METRICS & CREDIT SCHEDULE

This Exhibit B defines the operational performance requirements and support escalation protocols for the SaaS analytics platform under Article 8:

Severity Level	Response Time	Resolution Goal	Monthly Credit
Severity 1 (Critical Down)	< 30 Minutes	< 4 Hours	5% of Monthly SaaS Fee per hour
Severity 2 (High Degradation)	< 2 Hours	< 24 Hours	2% of Monthly SaaS Fee per SOW
Severity 3 (Normal Operations)	< 8 Hours	< 5 Business Days	N/A
Severity 4 (Information Request)	< 24 Hours	< 10 Business Days	N/A

EXHIBIT C — FUNDING & COST ALLOCATION SCHEDULE

The following table details the initial capital contributions, financial milestones, and operating budget allocations under Article 3:

Category	First Party Allocation	Second Party Allocation	Total Approved
Initial Capital Funding	\$2,500,000.00	\$2,500,000.00	\$5,000,000.00
Core Engineering Budget	\$1,500,000.00	\$500,000.00	\$2,000,000.00
Marketing & Sales Operations	\$200,000.00	\$1,800,000.00	\$2,000,000.00
Cloud Infrastructure & Scaling	\$800,000.00	\$200,000.00	\$1,000,000.00